



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2021-2022
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET B)

FULL MARKS: 50
TIME: 1 HOUR 30 MINUTES

General Instructions:

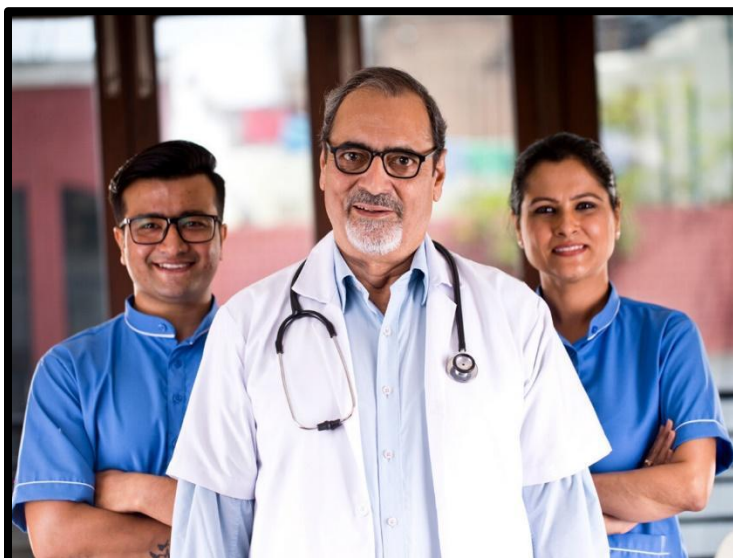
- This paper consists of four printed pages.
- Answers should be to the point.
- Copy the question numbers carefully before answering the questions.
- Marks will be deducted for spelling errors.

Question 1:

Write a composition (150-200 words) on any one of the following:

[10]

- a) You were walking towards the market place when you noticed a great commotion centred around a bleeding young man lying on the road. Describe the situation at that time and also mention what happened next.
- b) 'Every home should adopt a pet animal.' Express your views either for or against this statement.
- c) Study the picture given below. Write a story or an account of what the picture suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or may take suggestions from it but there must be a clear connection between the picture and the composition.



Question 2

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- a) You have decided to strengthen the bond of your friends by organizing an online drama. Write a letter to your best friend expressing your happiness and giving him a brief account of his part in the play, how he needs to prepare himself for the role and how this drama will usher a fresh breath of happiness and fun in your daily life.
- b) The main road leading to your locality has three open manholes(holes on the road surface with lids) causing frequent accidents at night, especially during the rainy season. Write a letter to the editor of a newspaper drawing the attention to this problem of the residents and seeking help to improve the condition of the roads in your locality.

Question 3

Your school is organising an Inter-School Photography Competition. Draft a notice for your school notice board giving relevant details of the event and inviting students from classes VIII to X to register their names.

[5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

Gift the Habit of Reading

Right from childhood, a human being starts enjoying the pleasure of reading. As a child, he learns the ways of life through reading and writing. He is thrilled by going through new little things and learning through them. Any new lesson that comes his way excites his emotions by giving his little mind the freshness of knowledge. The pleasure one derives from reading is indeed recreational as well as instructive. Reading sharpens your thought processes. It increases your attention span. It gives you the abilities of thinking and understanding. Reading a book aloud can be a good exercise not just for memorization but also for improvement of speech and vocabulary. Books trigger your power of imagination, too.

Reading of novels or other interesting literature makes a person forget the worries and cares of life. Reading of a newspaper, periodical, journal etc., which is light reading, gives the reader knowledge about human life around and solves his curiosity about the world. Newspaper and journals give information about the events taking place in the world and happenings in the state and the locality a person lives in. The newspapers also publish important news and views in the fields of economics, politics and science. Reading the newspaper is necessary for even a little educated citizen in modern society. Reading of novels is the most popular pastime of a large number of people. The attraction of a novel lies in its ability to create interest, to maintain it and take the reader to the heights of imagination and fiction. All fictions are somewhat connected with life and they give in words the picture drawn from real life or from imagination. As such, of all forms of literature, novels are the most popular and interesting. They portray pictures from our real life and society and present the character of the people we see around or wish to see. A novel inspires the interest

and intention of the reader because in it, scenes rapidly shift and change and there are unexpected turns of events giving shocks and shakes to the mind.

Next, we come to the books of travel and adventure. The spirit of adventure is in the very blood of man. A man wants glamour and romantic life, full of adventure and material spirit. Books of travel and adventure introduce a spirit of fearlessness in which the travellers, who are the heroes of the books, inspire in us. Among the books of adventure lies the best literature in the world. Whatever the type of books one reads, the reading is always a source of pleasure and enjoyment, the habit of reading is a sign of good culture. It is a source of knowledge and the best means of making use of one's leisure. Books are, after all, a goldmine of knowledge, art, literature and science. Books are not only useful and instructive but also entertaining and fun!

a) Give the meanings of the following words as used in the passage. One word answers or short phrases will be accepted. [2]

i) Trigger-

ii) Glamour-

b) Answer the following questions briefly:

i) Give three benefits of reading. [3]

ii) How can reading a newspaper widen our knowledge? [2]

iii) 'Among the books of adventure lies the best literature in the world'- Why does the narrator say the above line? [2]

iv) Which phrase from the passage proves that the author wants to encourage you to gift a book? [1]

c) In not more than 50 words, write why novels are the most popular and interesting form of literature. [5]

Question 5 [4]

Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write the numbers and answer with the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. Example: 0 was

Our first impression on entering the grounds ___0___ (be) that the whole thing ___1___ (look) like a fairyland. The vast space ___2___ (decorate) in bright and gay colours, men and women in their best clothes ___3___ (be) moving from corner to corner, admiring the beauty of all the stalls. These stalls ___4___ (be) like small shops and they had of sale a variety of foods. While the stalls ___5___ (make) a very interesting site, what ___6___ (attract) us most was the children's corner. It ___7___ (surround) with boys and girls. All types of amusements ___8___ (see).

Question 6

[6]

Do as directed:

- i) Priti asked me a riddle. I was unable to solve it. (Join without using *and*, *but* or *so*.)**
- ii) I haven't seen you in a million years. (Identify the Figure of speech in the given sentence.)**
- iii) I composed a poem..... (in the garden, at dusk, slowly) (Rewrite the sentence using the words and phrases in brackets and put them in the correct position.)**
- iv) Traditionally, these days were _____for special prayer and fasting. (Fill in the blank with a suitable Phrasal Verb.)**
- v) Keep your book on the table. (Change into Passive Voice.)**
- vi) Bhola said, "Granny, please give me ten rupees to buy a chocolate now" (Change into Indirect speech.)**